# Indiana Esports Network

# Marvel Rivals

## Competition Ruleset

### 2026-2027

**Competition Status:**
Varsity / JV

**Competition Format:**
Team-Based

**Platform:**
Cross Platform (PC, Xbox, Playstation)

Ruleset Version: 1.03

Effective Date: 11/2/26

# Document Information

| Information | Details |
|---|---|
| Game Title | Marvel Rivals |
| Publisher | NetEase Games |
| Season | 9.5 |
| Competition Level | Varsity / JV |
| Version | 1.03 |
| Effective Date | 11/2/26 |

# Quick Reference

This section provides a summary of the most important competition information.

| Category | Information |
|---|---|
| Competition Type | Team |
| Platform | PC, Xbox, Playstation |
| Team Size | 6 Starters, 3 Subs |
| Maximum Roster | 9 |
| Match Format | Bo3 |
| Match Length | 15-30 mins per map |
| Scoring System | Match Win 1 point<br>Match Loss 0 point |
| Playoff Format | Bo3 |
| Championship Format | Bo5 |

# Coach Checklist

## Before the Season

☐ Register team/player information with IEN
☐ Verify student eligibility
☐ Review competition rules
☐ Confirm required equipment
☐ Ensure players have approved accounts
☐ Review schedule and deadlines

## Before Each Match

☐ Confirm roster availability
☐ Update game software
☐ Verify settings

☐ Confirm opponent communication
☐ Prepare required equipment

# 1. Competition Overview

## 1.1 Purpose

The Indiana Esports Network (IEN) establishes this ruleset to define the official competition standards for **Marvel Rivals**.

This document provides the information required for schools, coaches, and students to participate in IEN competition.

All participants must also follow the requirements established in the current IEN Member Handbook.

## 1.2 Competition Model

**Competition Type:**

Team-Based

**Description:**

Marvel Rivals is a competitive team-based hero shooter in which two schools compete using teams of six players. Players choose from a roster of Marvel superheroes and villains, each with unique abilities and playstyles that contribute to a team's overall strategy. Teams battle across objective-based maps, earning victories by successfully completing objectives while preventing their opponents from doing the same. Success requires teamwork, communication, strategic coordination, and effective use of hero abilities throughout the match.

# 2. Team and Player Structure

## 2.1 Roster Information

| Requirement | Details |
|---|---|
| Minimum Roster | 6 starters<br>1sub |
| Maximum Roster | 9 |
| Active Players | 6 |
| Substitutes | 3 |

## 2.2 Coaches

Coach requirements:

All coach eligibility, supervision, and participation requirements are governed by the IEN Bylaws and General Competition Rules.

# 3. Match Format

## 3.1 Competition Format

Marvel Rivals competitions shall be conducted in a **6-versus-6 team format**, with each school fielding six eligible players and up to three substitutes. Players may switch heroes during gameplay in accordance with game rules, and there are no role restrictions on team composition.

## 3.2 Match Structure

Regular season matches shall be played as a **Best-of-Three (Bo3)** series.

The first team to win **two (2) maps** shall be declared the match winner.

Maps shall be played in the prescribed order of:

1. Domination
2. Convoy
3. Convergence (if necessary)

### Side Selection

- For the first map, the designated home team shall be assigned as Team 1 and the away team as Team 2.
- For subsequent maps, the team that lost the previous map shall select its side.

### Hero Selection

- Matches shall use the current IEN-approved tournament settings, including the applicable hero ban and lock system.
- Heroes restricted by the game's ranked competitive mode or otherwise prohibited by IEN shall not be eligible for play.

### Substitutions

- Teams may substitute eligible rostered players between maps.
- No substitutions may occur during an active map except as otherwise authorized by league administration.

## 3.3 Tie Procedures

If a tie occurs:

If teams are tied after the three scheduled maps, a random Domination map will be played and the winner of that map will be declared the match winner.

# 4. Competition Schedule

## 4.1 Regular Season

Season dates:

Preseason 10/15/26-10/29/26

Regular Season 11/5/26-12/10/26

Winter Break 12/11/26-1/3/27

Regular Season (continue) 1/7/27 - 2/11/27

Playoffs 2/25/27 - 3/18/27

## 4.2 Map Schedule

Regular season maps are listed by competition week. Play each row from left to right. The third map is played if necessary.

| Week | Domination | Convoy | Convergence |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Birnin T'Challa | Thebes | Central Park |
| 2 | Krakoa | Spider-Islands | Hall of Djalia |
| 3 | Celestial Husk | Yggdrasill Path | Lower Manhattan |
| 4 | God Quarry | Midtown | Heart of Heaven |
| 5 | Hell's Heaven | Arakko | Symbiotic Surface |
| 6 | Royal Palace | Museum of Contemplation | Shin-Shibuya |
| 7 | Birnin T'Challa | Midtown | Heart of Heaven |
| 8 | Celestial Husk | Thebes | Lower Manhattan |
| 9 | God Quarry | Spider-Islands | Hall of Djalia |
| 10 | Krakoa | Yggdrasill Path | Central Park |

### Playoff Map Schedule

| Playoff Round | Domination | Convoy | Convergence | Domination | Convoy |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Round of 32 | Birnin T'Challa | Yggdrasil Path | Lower Manhattan | | |
| Round of 16 | Royal Palace | Arakko | Shin-Shibuya | | |
| Round of 8 | God Quarry | Midtown | Heart of Heaven | | |
| Semi Finals | Hell's Heaven | Thebes | Symbiotic Surface | | |
| Finals (Bo5) | Celestial Husk | Spider-Islands | Central Park | *Krakoa** | *Museum of Contemplation** |

Finals maps marked with an asterisk are played only if necessary.

# 5. Official Game Settings

## 5.1 Required Settings

IEN competitions will use:

- Server: NA North Virginia
- Tournament Room
- Lock Room: Checked
- Join Access: Invitation Only
- Spectator Access: No Spectating
    - Coach slots in the lobby can still be used to spectate
- Ban/Pick Settings: Tournament (Basic)
- Format: 3 (for Bo3)
- Pause Permissions: Yes for player and coach
- **Disable Balance Latency (upper right of teams)**
- Default character skins only

## 5.2 Approved Maps / Arenas / Courses / Stages

Maps shall be played according to the regular season and playoff schedules in Section 4.2. Convergence is played only if necessary in a Best-of-Three series.

## 5.3 Restricted Content

The following are not permitted:

- Any heroes currently disabled in the ranked queue will be unavailable for IEN matches. Any newly released heroes will be unavailable for IEN matches for a period of 2 weeks after official release.

## 5.4 Pick-Ban Process

Clicking Start will take all participants to the ban-lock process, where team leaders (person at the top of their respective team's side of the lobby) will take turns banning and locking heroes. Locking a hero prevents them from being banned later. The process proceeds as follows:

- Right side team bans a hero.
- Left side team bans a hero.

- Left side team locks a hero.
- Right side team locks a hero.
- Right side team bans a hero.
- Left side team bans a hero.
- Left side team locks a hero.
- Right side team locks a hero.
- Right side team bans a hero.
- Left side team bans a hero.

Missed bans/picks will result in no hero being selected, resulting in the team losing the ban/pick. After the ban-lock process is complete, up to six (6) total heroes will be removed from play depending on the number of heroes banned. Each team will then pick their heroes and enter the match.

## 5.5 Side Selection

Loser of previous map selects side for next map.  If the previous map ended in a draw, the team that most recently picked a side will again pick a side.

## 5.6 Scheduled Maps

Use the scheduled maps in Section 4.2. Map bans do not apply to these scheduled matches. The finals are Best-of-Five; the first team to win three maps wins. Finals maps 4 and 5 are played only if necessary.

# 6. Document History

| **Version** | Date | **Changes** |
|---|---|---|
| 1.0 | 8/3/26 | Initial Release |
| 1.01 | 8/23/26 | Added Map Bans procedure |
| 1.02 | 9/16/26 | Fixed number of players in section 2.1 |
| 1.03 | 11/2/26 | Combined regular season and playoff map schedules; replaced map bans with scheduled maps; clarified Best-of-Five finals; corrected January season year. |